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Use this workbook to evaluate and compare drink shop concepts. Copy the **Idea Overview** block below for each new concept you want to explore.

Idea name: _____

Date evaluated: _____

Status: ☐ Exploring · ☐ Researching · ☐ Planning · ☐ Go · ☐ No-go

Title

- ☐ Name is memorable and easy to say
- ☐ Name reflects the concept (drinks, vibe, or locality)
- ☐ Domain and social handles are available (or acceptable alternatives exist)
- ☐ No trademark conflicts with existing brands

Working title:

Description

- ☐ One-sentence pitch is clear
- ☐ Concept is differentiated from nearby competitors
- ☐ Core products are defined (coffee, tea, boba, smoothies, juice, cocktails-to-go, etc.)
- ☐ Pricing tier is identified (budget / mid / premium)

What is it? (*2–3 sentences*)

Vision — What Would It Look Like?

- ☐ Interior aesthetic is defined (modern, cozy, industrial, tropical, etc.)
- ☐ Seating capacity and layout are estimated

- ☐ Drive-through, walk-up window, or counter-only model is chosen
- ☐ Brand colors, logo direction, and signage concept are sketched
- ☐ Customer experience from entry to exit is mapped out

Describe the space and vibe:

Element	Plan
Square footage	
Seating	
Counter / ordering flow	
Kitchen / prep area	
Ambiance (music, lighting, decor)	
Signature visual feature	

Target Demographics

- ☐ Primary age range identified
- ☐ Income and spending habits considered
- ☐ Lifestyle fit confirmed (students, commuters, families, fitness, nightlife, etc.)
- ☐ Peak hours and dayparts mapped (morning rush, lunch, evening, weekend)
- ☐ Discovery channels defined (foot traffic, social, drive-by, apps)

Audience	Profile
Primary	
Secondary	
Why they'll choose you	

Potential Localities — DFW Area

Rate each area: **Fit (1–5) · Rent estimate · Competition · Notes**

Dallas

- ☐ **Deep Ellum / Downtown** — arts, nightlife, young professionals
- ☐ **Uptown / Knox-Henderson** — high income, walkable, competitive
- ☐ **Bishop Arts / Oak Cliff** — local charm, growing food scene
- ☐ **Lower Greenville / M Streets** — residential + bar/restaurant corridor
- ☐ **Design District / Trinity Groves** — mixed use, destination dining

Fort Worth

- ☐ **Sundance Square / Downtown** — events, tourism, office workers
- ☐ **West 7th / Cultural District** — young crowd, entertainment
- ☐ **Camp Bowie / Near Southside** — neighborhood feel, growth

Suburbs & corridors

- ☐ **Plano — Legacy West / Shops at Legacy** — affluent suburbs, corporate campuses
- ☐ **Frisco / The Star area** — families, sports/events traffic, new development
- ☐ **McKinney — Downtown Square** — charm, events, suburban draw
- ☐ **Arlington — Entertainment District / UTA area** — students, game-day traffic
- ☐ **Richardson / Telecom Corridor** — diverse, office lunch crowd
- ☐ **Irving / Las Colinas** — corporate parks, mixed residential
- ☐ **Garland / Mesquite / east DFW** — lower rent, underserved pockets
- ☐ **DFW Airport / travel corridor** — high turnover, grab-and-go (if applicable)

Top 3 location candidates:

Rank	Area / corridor	Why
1		
2		
3		

Site requirements:

- ☐ Minimum sq ft: ____
- ☐ Parking or walkability score: ____
- ☐ Visibility from main road: ____
- ☐ Proximity to anchors (schools, offices, gyms, retail): ____
- ☐ Zoning allows food/beverage use: ____

Drawbacks & Risks

- ☐ High competition in target areas acknowledged
- ☐ Seasonality and weather impact considered (Texas heat, occasional cold snaps)
- ☐ Labor costs and staffing difficulty assessed
- ☐ Supply chain and ingredient spoilage risks noted
- ☐ Health department and liquor (if any) permitting complexity understood
- ☐ Economic downturn sensitivity considered
- ☐ Franchise vs. independent trade-offs weighed

Top drawbacks:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Risk	Mitigation

Profit Potential

- ☐ Average ticket size estimated: \$____
- ☐ Target transactions per day: ____
- ☐ Gross margin on drinks estimated: ____% (*typical range 60–75% for beverages*)

Monthly revenue projection:

Scenario	Daily customers	Avg ticket	Monthly revenue
Conservative			
Base			
Optimistic			

- ☐ Fixed costs (rent, utilities, insurance, loan): \$____ / month
- ☐ Variable costs (COGS, labor ~25–35%): \$____ / month
- ☐ Break-even timeline: ____ months
- ☐ Net profit margin target: ____%

Notes on profitability:

Future Growth Potential

- ☐ Second location feasibility considered
- ☐ Catering and corporate accounts opportunity
- ☐ Mobile cart, pop-up, or festival revenue streams
- ☐ Bottling or retail packaged products
- ☐ Franchise or licensing model (long term)
- ☐ Extended hours or seasonal menu expansion
- ☐ Delivery and app partnerships (DoorDash, Uber Eats, etc.)

Growth paths (ranked):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Community Growth Potential

- ☐ Local partnerships identified (schools, gyms, offices, events)
- ☐ Loyalty program or membership concept
- ☐ Community events (open mic, trivia, tastings, workshops)
- ☐ Social media and UGC strategy for neighborhood buzz
- ☐ Hiring locally and being a visible neighborhood business
- ☐ Sustainability or local sourcing angle (if relevant)

How will this shop become part of the community?

Starting Capital Requirements

Estimate each line item; adjust for build-out vs. turnkey space.

Item	Low	Mid	High
Lease deposit + first month rent			
Build-out / renovation			
Equipment (espresso, blenders, refrigeration, POS)			
Furniture and fixtures			
Initial inventory and supplies			
Permits, licenses, legal, accounting			
Insurance (GL, property, workers comp)			
Signage and branding			
Marketing launch budget			
Working capital (3–6 months reserve)			
Total estimated startup			

Funding snapshot:

- ☐ Personal savings available: \$____
- ☐ SBA loan / bank financing explored: \$____
- ☐ Investors or partners identified: \$____
- ☐ Gap to close: \$____

Steps for Getting Started

Phase 1 — Validate the drink concept

- ☐ Visit 10+ comparable shops in DFW; note menu, pricing, rush-hour flow, and gaps
- ☐ Identify your signature angle (specialty coffee, boba, fresh juice, tea program, etc.)
- ☐ Run taste tests or pop-up samples with your target demo
- ☐ Define MVP menu (5–10 core drinks plus 2–3 modifiers or add-ons)
- ☐ Develop recipes and cost each drink (COGS per cup, including ice, milk, toppings)
- ☐ Test drink consistency and speed — can you hit target ticket time during a mock rush?

Phase 2 — Build the drink program

- ☐ Source core suppliers (coffee roaster, tea, boba/toppings, syrups, dairy/alternatives, cups/lids)
- ☐ Spec bar equipment (espresso machine, grinders, blenders, ice maker, refrigeration, hot water)
- ☐ Design bar layout for rush flow (order → prep → handoff; minimize steps between stations)
- ☐ Choose cup sizes, ice program, and to-go vs. dine-in packaging
- ☐ Plan cold storage and par levels for short-shelf-life items (milk, fruit, pearls, pastries)
- ☐ Decide on add-ons and upsells (extra shots, alternative milk, boba, seasonal LTOs)

Phase 3 — Permits and build-out (beverage-specific)

- ☐ Apply for food establishment permit (local health department — covers beverage prep)

- ☐ Complete food handler / certified food manager training (Texas requirement)
- ☐ If serving alcohol: TABC license research and application
- ☐ Confirm plumbing, drainage, and electrical load for espresso, ice, and refrigeration
- ☐ Finalize floor plan with health inspector in mind (handwash sink, sanitizer, temp storage)
- ☐ Pass health inspection (ice handling, milk storage temps, cleaning logs, sanitizer concentration)

Phase 4 — Dial in and launch the menu

- ☐ Hire and train lead barista on recipes, portioning, and consistency standards
- ☐ Dial in espresso grind, brew ratios, and blender times for every menu item
- ☐ Set opening/closing prep lists (batch syrups, cook pearls, calibrate grinders, restock bar)
- ☐ Run soft opening focused on drink quality, speed, and waste (not general business ops)
- ☐ Lock supplier delivery schedule for perishables before grand opening

Steps for Running the Place

Daily operations

- ☐ Opening checklist (equipment, inventory, cash drawer, cleanliness)
- ☐ Prep standards and recipes documented for consistency
- ☐ Peak-hour staffing schedule locked
- ☐ Closing checklist (clean, restock, secure, deposit)
- ☐ Daily sales and waste log review

Weekly

- ☐ Inventory order and vendor reconciliation
- ☐ Staff schedule published
- ☐ Social media content posted
- ☐ Review customer feedback (Google, Yelp, in-store)
- ☐ Equipment maintenance check

Monthly

- ☐ P&L review vs. budget
- ☐ Labor cost % and COGS % tracked
- ☐ Menu performance — promote winners, cut losers
- ☐ Local marketing or event planning
- ☐ Staff training refresh or team meeting

Quarterly / ongoing

- ☐ Lease and insurance renewals on calendar
- ☐ Health inspection readiness
- ☐ Seasonal menu or LTO planning
- ☐ Community partnership outreach
- ☐ Evaluate expansion, catering, or second location triggers

Key metrics to watch

Metric	Target
Labor cost % of sales	<= 30–35%
COGS %	<= 25–30%
Average ticket	\$
Daily transactions	
Customer return rate	
Online review rating	>= 4.5

Final Decision Scorecard

Rate each area 1–5 before committing.

Criterion	Score (1–5)	Notes
Concept clarity		
Market demand		
Location options		
Profit potential		
Growth potential		
Community fit		
Capital readiness		
Risk / drawback tolerance		
Total / 40		

Go / no-go decision: _____

Next action by: _____

Additional Ideas (*quick capture*)

Title	One-line pitch	Priority
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